

1. SHAHEED BHAGAT SINGH - Historical Facts (119th Birth Anniversary)

- **Born:** 28 September 1907, in present-day Punjab region of **Pakistan**. The recent birth anniversary celebrated was the **119th** (number can be asked in exams).
- **Death:** hanged (executed) on **23 March 1931**, remembered as **Shaheed Diwas**. Three names to remember: **Bhagat Singh, Sukhdev, Rajguru**. The British were so afraid that they hanged them a night before the scheduled date.
- **Last wish:** asked for his final wish, he said a few pages (about 18-19) of the book he was reading remained; he wanted to finish it first. Died at only 23.
- **Uncle:** Ajit Singh (his name often appears with Bhagat Singh's).
- **Organisations:** Hindustan Republican Association (**1925**); Naujawan Bharat Sabha (**1926**); Hindustan Socialist Republican Association/Party (**1928**).
- **1929 Central Assembly Bomb:** thrown by Bhagat Singh with **Batukeshwar Dutt** in protest against a public act/law then being introduced. This case is known as the **Lahore Conspiracy**.
- **Book:** 'Why I Am an Atheist' (asked many times in exams). **Publications/journals:** 'Kirti' and 'Veer Arjun'.
- **Motto/Aim:** 'Hate the system, not the country.'

MCQ

Which book did Bhagat Singh write? **Ans: Why I Am an Atheist.** | Which number birth anniversary was celebrated? **Ans: 119th.**

REVISE

Born 28-09-1907 | Hanged 23-03-1931 (Shaheed Diwas) | HRA 1925, NBS 1926, HSRA 1928 | Bomb 1929 with B.K. Dutt | Lahore Conspiracy | Kirti, Veer Arjun

2. QUICK QUESTIONS - Railway and Defence

- **Sarai railway station** falls in the **North East Frontier Railway** zone. India has **18 railway zones** in total.
- **Defence:** Under **Atmanirbhar Bharat / Make in India**, the Ministry of Defence recently signed a deal of about **Rs. 1,950 crore** to buy **mountain radars** from **Bharat Electronics Limited (BEL)**.

MCQ

Sarai station zone? **Ans: North East Frontier Railway.** | Company for mountain radars (Rs. 1,950 cr)? **Ans: Bharat Electronics Limited (BEL).**

3. ELECTION COMMISSION OF INDIA (ECI) - Hot and Burning Topic

- **Formation:** **25 January 1950**; it is a **constitutional body** and a **multi-member body** of 3 members: 1 **Chief Election Commissioner (CEC)** + 2 **Election Commissioners**. **National Voters' Day = 25 January.**
- **Present members:** CEC **Gyanesh Kumar**; Election Commissioners **Sandhu** and **Vivek Joshi**.
- **Consensus point:** as explained in class, if the three do not agree on an issue it cannot be applied as a rule, so agreement of all three is needed. (Extra note: under the 1991 Act the law actually provides for decisions by majority.)
- **Trigger:** a survey by **The Indian Express** claimed many decisions were taken by one member without asking the others. In response, all three held a joint **press conference**.
- **Point 1 - 'We are like a family':** disagreements happen in a family, but every decision in **Goa, Bihar and West Bengal** elections was taken by all three together.
- **Point 2 - Senior citizens:** if a senior citizen's name is missing from the voter list, they need not apply anywhere. The **BLO (Booth Level Officer)** will go **door to door** and get the names added. The same applies to any person missing from the list.

3. ECI (continued)

- **Point 3 - SIR (Special Intensive Revision):** voter lists are revised: names of people present stay, names of those not present are removed. Many genuine voters get dropped in the process. **Form 6** is the special form; people were asked to prove Indian citizenship. ECI said if many names are missing after SIR, there is no problem: the **BLO** will visit and include the names in the list.
- **Point 4 - Labourers/daily workers:** because they move place to place, voter registration is difficult. They can simply go to the **District Magistrate** and register their name, or get help at the booth where someone will assist and their vote will be made.
- **Point 5 - ECI NET Review (most important, as explained in class):** the right/power to decide whose name is in the voter list was with the **States**; there was a proposal to shift it to the **Central Government**, which caused a dispute. To resolve it, a **Review Committee** with senior **IIT professors** will decide whether the power stays with the State or the Centre. Expect: 'What is ECI NET? Full form? Who holds the power?' ECI = **Election Commission of India**.
- **Nine pointers** were made in the conference; only those likely to come in exams were covered.
- **Appointment:** by the **President**. **Removal:** not easy; a full process similar to **impeachment** (different from the President's impeachment) and it needs a **majority**. **Term: 6 years** or up to **65 years of age**.

MCQ

National Voters' Day date? **Ans: 25 January**. | Which is NOT covered under the 'PM ... initiative' question? **Ans: Pragyan Mission** (question text garbled in the recording). | Full forms to learn: **BLO, SIR, ECI**.

REVISE

ECI formed 25-01-1950 | 3 members | appointed by President | 6 yrs / 65 yrs | BLO = Booth Level Officer | SIR = Special Intensive Revision | Form 6

4. INTERNATIONAL AND BILATERAL

- **UNESCO (Sikkim): Lepcha Traditional Cane Bridge (Rusom)** is a symbol of **Sikkim**, being taken to the UNESCO list (tie-up with government).
- **Iran completes rail route:** from **Chabahar to Zahedan** (Zahedan is right on the Balochistan border, next to Pakistan). It extends on to **Zaranj and Delaram in Afghanistan**, so it links Iran and Afghanistan with India's help. Length about **630-750 km**; work began in **2010** (sandy, rocky terrain delayed it).
- **Why it matters:** **Chabahar Port** (Iran, Gulf of Oman) is developed by **India**. Gujarat and Maharashtra link to it by sea. It lets India trade with Iran, Afghanistan and Europe **bypassing Pakistan**. Next door is **Gwadar Port** (Pakistan, Balochistan), developed by **China**.
- **Iran facts:** capital **Tehran**; new member of **BRICS** and **SCO**. **Wagah Border** lies between **Punjab (India) and Pakistan**; **Khyber Pass** was mentioned as being on the Afghanistan side (it is between Afghanistan and Pakistan).
- **Commemorative gift exchange 2026:** India exchanged a gift/stamp featuring Nobel laureate **Rabindranath Tagore** with **Sweden**.
- **FIFA World Cup 2026:** co-hosted by **USA, Canada and Mexico**. Winner **Spain** (2nd title), runner-up **Argentina**.

MCQ

Which state has the Lepcha cane bridge? **Ans: Sikkim**. | Rail route completed by Iran? **Ans: Chabahar to Zahedan**. | Country that exchanged Tagore gift? **Ans: Sweden**. | FIFA 2026 winner? **Ans: Spain** (co-hosts USA, Canada, Mexico).

5. MEGA PORTS, ECONOMY AND SCHEMES

- **Indian Ports Act 2025 - Mega Ports declared** (criteria fixed in June, announced now; based on cargo/trade volume, together about **150 million metric tonnes**):
- 1) **Deendayal (Kandla)**, Gujarat, now Deendayal Upadhyay Port; 2) **Jawaharlal Nehru Port**, Maharashtra (new name Nhava Sheva); 3) **Paradip**, Odisha; 4) **Mundra**, Gujarat, developed by **Adani** (first private-company introduction).
- Act falls under the **Ministry of Shipping** (Minister **Sarbananda Sonowal**); present ambassador: **Manu Bhaker**.
- **IIT Madras:** Finance Minister **Nirmala Sitharaman** launched the **Unicorn Venture Fund**. A **Unicorn** is a company valued above **USD 1 billion**. The fund introduces unicorns to campus recruiters so they can invest.
- **FSSAI:** Act of **2006**; ensures **safe food** for people of India; **Eat Right India Movement** focuses on right food and better life. **Both statements correct**.
- **Padma Vibhushan 2026:** **two** awarded posthumously: **Dharmendra** and **V. S. Achuthanandan**.

MCQ

Which port is Mega Port under Indian Ports Act 2025? **Ans: All - Deendayal, Jawaharlal Nehru, Paradip**. | FSSAI statements? **Ans: Both correct**. | Posthumous Padma Vibhushan 2026? **Ans: 2**.

6. ENVIRONMENT AND HEALTH

- **Cool Leader Award 2026:** given by **UNEP (UN Environment Programme)** to those who help **cool the Earth's temperature**. Winners: **Singapore** (capital: Singapore City), **UAE** (capital: Abu Dhabi) and **Dong Mingjun** (a person; spelled 'Dong Manjo' in the recording).
- Presented at the **Global Cooling Assembly 2026**, hosted in **Singapore**. Award was announced at **COP28** (UAE). UNEP was created **5 June 1972** - celebrated as **World Environment Day**.
- **COP series:** COP28 UAE | COP29 **Baku** | COP30 **Brazil** | COP31 **Turkey** | COP32 **Ethiopia** | COP33 was to be in India but will **not** be. Paris deal (COP21): keep warming under **1.5 deg C** (already crossed).
- **Sickle Cell:** India is co-hosting the **Global Partnership for Sickle Cell Care** alongside the **81st UN General Assembly session** in **New York** (UN HQ); India represented by **S. Jaishankar**. In sickle cell anaemia, **RBCs become sickle (C) shaped**. India's target to end it: **2047**; the world has now also set **2047**.

MCQ Cool Leader Award 2026 winners? **Ans: Singapore, UAE, Dong Mingjun.** | Who launched the award? **Ans: UNEP.**

7. SPORTS

- **Asian Games - 20th edition, Nagoya (Japan):** Squash. **Anahat Singh** (19 yrs) won **Silver** in women's singles - **third Indian woman** to win a medal (earlier **bronze** by **Dipika Pallikal** and **Joshna Chinappa**). **Abhay Singh** won **Silver** in men's - **2nd Indian man** with silver; first was **Saurav Ghosal** (2014, 2023). **Malaysia** won both golds, gaining a direct quota for **LA Olympics 2028**.
- **Pole Vault: Baranika Elangovan** (spelled 'Bernika Allen Govan' in the recording) won **Bronze** at **4.15 m**, sharing it with **Polina (Kazakhstan)**. India's **first-ever** Asian Games pole vault medal (men and women both). Gold: **Japan**; Silver: **China**.
- **Virat Kohli: second batter to score 15,000 ODI runs** (first: **Sachin Tendulkar**). Scored **139 off 88 balls** vs **West Indies** (9 hits as taught, likely sixes); it was his **55th ODI century** (54th was vs New Zealand). He took **338 innings** vs Sachin's 538 as stated in class (please verify these figures); **10 records** broken; also fastest by innings.
- **Chess Olympiad 2026, Samarkand (Uzbekistan):** India won **Silver** (drew with **Hungary**; beat Germany, who took **Bronze**); **Gold: Uzbekistan**. Players: **D. Gukesh, Arjun, Praggnanandhaa, Nihal**. India has **99 Grandmasters**; newest: **Rathanvel**; will reach 100 by end-2026.
- **FIDE** (chess body): formed **1924**, HQ **Lausanne**; President **Timur** (Kazakhstan, as spelled in recording); Deputy President **Viswanathan Anand**.

MCQ 3rd Indian to win Asian Games women's singles squash medal? **Ans: Anahat Singh.** | Baranika Elangovan medal sport? **Ans: Pole Vault.** | Second batter to 15,000 ODI runs? **Ans: Virat Kohli.** | Chess Olympiad India medal? **Ans: Silver.**

8. SUMMITS, ALLIANCES AND TRANSPORT

- **18th BRICS Summit (hosted by India):** theme = **Resilience, Innovation, Cooperation and Sustainability**.
- **International Big Cat Alliance (Delhi):** aims to highlight India's **Cheetah conservation model** and share best practices globally, and to strengthen knowledge, capacity building and collaboration. **Both statements correct.**
- **India's first LNG-powered train:** flagged off from **Sabarmati** (Gujarat) by **Amit Shah** (Gandhinagar MP); route **Sabarmati to Mehsana Junction**; **dual fuel (LNG + diesel)**, cuts diesel dependence by **~40%**; **1,400 HP**; range up to **2,000 km**. LNG = **Liquefied Natural Gas** (methane, butane, propane, ethane, nitrogen). Hydrogen train was trialled in **Haryana**.

MCQ BRICS 18th summit theme? **Ans: Resilience, Innovation, Cooperation and Sustainability.** | Full form LNG / route? **Ans: Liquefied Natural Gas; Sabarmati to Mehsana.**

REVISE Homework: answer the class questions in comment section. Class PDF is on Telegram (Current Affairs by Kriti). Test-series/combination on Testbook; first-shift analysis before 12:00, full analysis at 7 PM next day.

ALL MCQs FROM TODAY'S CLASS - with Answers

Q.	Question	Answer
1	Bhagat Singh: which birth anniversary was celebrated?	119th
2	Book written by Bhagat Singh?	Why I Am an Atheist
3	Journals/publications by Bhagat Singh?	Kirti and Veer Arjun
4	Sarai railway station falls in which zone (of 18)?	North East Frontier Railway
5	Company chosen for Rs. 1,950 cr mountain radars?	Bharat Electronics Limited (BEL)
6	On which date is National Voters' Day celebrated / ECI formed?	25 January (1950)
7	Which is NOT covered under the 'PM ... initiative' (garbled)?	Pragyan Mission
8	Lepcha Traditional Cane Bridge (Rusom) belongs to?	Sikkim
9	Iran completed which rail route?	Chabahar to Zahedan
10	Country that exchanged Tagore commemorative gift with India?	Sweden
11	FIFA World Cup 2026 co-hosts / winner?	USA, Canada, Mexico / Spain
12	Mega Port under Indian Ports Act 2025?	All: Deendayal, JNPA, Paradip
13	FSSAI Act 2006 and Eat Right India statements?	Both correct
14	Posthumous Padma Vibhushan 2026 count?	2 (Dharmendra, V.S. Achuthanandan)
15	Cool Leader Award 2026 winners?	Singapore, UAE, Dong Mingjun
16	Who launched Cool Leader Award?	UNEP
17	Third Indian woman with Asian Games squash medal?	Anahat Singh (Silver)
18	Baranika Elangovan won medal in?	Pole Vault (Bronze, 4.15 m)
19	Chess Olympiad 2026 - India's medal / venue?	Silver / Samarkand, Uzbekistan
20	18th BRICS Summit theme?	Resilience, Innovation, Cooperation and Sustainability
21	Big Cat Alliance statements (Cheetah model; capacity)?	Both correct
22	Second batter with 15,000 ODI runs?	Virat Kohli
23	Full form LNG; India's first LNG train route?	Liquefied Natural Gas; Sabarmati to Mehsana
24	Who flagged off the LNG train?	Amit Shah
25	Total railway zones in India?	18
26	Latest (99th) Indian Grandmaster?	Rathanvel
27	Deputy President of FIDE / HQ?	Viswanathan Anand / Lausanne
28	Wagah Border lies between?	Punjab (India) and Pakistan
29	Who is the Chief Election Commissioner?	Gyanesh Kumar
30	Full forms: BLO / SIR / ECI?	Booth Level Officer / Special Intensive Revision / Election Commission of India